

Midpoint Composite Charts in Astrology

Overview of Composite Charts and Their Uses

A **composite chart** is an astrology chart that represents the “birth” of a relationship by taking the midpoint between two individuals’ natal planetary positions ¹. In practice, each planet (and key point like the Ascendant/Midheaven) in a composite is located at the mathematical midpoint between the two people’s positions for that body ². The result is a single horoscope – **the chart of the relationship itself** – that reflects the combined energy or *third entity* formed when two people come together ³ ⁴. This midpoint-based technique was first introduced in the early 1970s by astrologer **John Townley**, who published *The Composite Chart* in 1973 and is recognized as the originator who popularized the method ⁵. Notably, composites are a modern development – prior to the 1970s, relationship astrology relied solely on synastry (direct chart comparison) ⁶.

How Composite Charts Differ from Synastry and Davison Charts: Unlike synastry, which examines how two separate natal charts interact (e.g. *“Your Venus is on my Mars, triggering a response in me”* ⁷), a composite chart fuses two charts into one. It doesn’t show *how you affect me* or vice versa, but rather reveals the character of the relationship as a standalone entity ⁷ ⁸. In other words, synastry highlights the chemistry and personal feelings between individuals, whereas the composite describes the *atmosphere and destiny of the partnership itself* ⁷ ⁹. It’s often said that *“one plus one equals three”* – the two people and the relationship they create are three distinct factors ³.

Composite charts are also distinct from **Davison Relationship Charts**, which are calculated by finding the midpoint in time and space (latitude/longitude) between two births (yielding an actual date and location) ¹⁰. The Davison method (named after Ronald Davison, who introduced it in 1977) produces a real horoscope that can be treated like a natal chart of the relationship, whereas the midpoint composite is a purely symbolic construct ¹⁰. Both techniques assume the relationship is an entity with its own chart, but **in this discussion we focus on midpoint-based composites**, as they are calculated directly from midpoints in the zodiac rather than an intermediary time/place.

Key Applications of Composite Charts: Since their introduction, composite charts have become a central tool in modern relationship astrology. Uses of midpoint composites include:

- **Romantic and Personal Relationships:** The most common use is to gain insight into love partnerships, marriages, and close one-on-one relationships. The composite reveals the *personality* of the couple as a unit – their joint strengths, challenges, emotional tone, and purpose as a partnership ¹¹ ⁸. For example, the composite Sun describes the core identity or purpose of the relationship, the composite Moon its emotional climate, composite Mercury the couple’s communication style, and so on ¹². Astrologers use these factors to understand the relationship’s dynamics beyond what each individual’s chart alone would indicate. The composite chart can show areas where the couple naturally thrives versus where they face tension, offering deep psychological insight into *“how the relationship feels”* and what it needs in order to grow or stay healthy ⁸. It effectively serves as a “cosmic care-and-feeding manual” for the partnership’s inner workings ¹³.

- **Friendships, Family Dynamics, and Group Relations:** Composite charts are not limited to romance. They can be cast for **any relationship** – friendships, siblings, parent-child relationships, or even broader group dynamics. For instance, a parent-child composite might illuminate the unique tone of that relationship (e.g. a composite Moon in 4th house could indicate a very emotionally rooted, nurturing parent-child bond). In family or household analysis, astrologers sometimes examine the composite charts between parents, or between a parent and each child, to understand family patterns. Composite techniques have even been expanded to **multi-person composites** for groups: AstroDienst (Astro.com) provides “multi-composite” charts for 3 or more people, useful for analyzing family units, teams, or other collectives ¹⁴. This can show how the group as a whole functions and how dynamics shift if a member joins or leaves ¹⁵.
- **Professional and Vocational Partnerships:** In business astrology, composite charts can shed light on partnerships between colleagues, co-founders, or an employee and an organization. Any two entities with a working relationship can form a composite chart. For example, one might examine the composite of two business partners to see the nature of their collaboration and joint potential for success ¹⁶. A strong 10th-house emphasis in a business composite could suggest the partnership has a prominent public role or career significance, whereas a challenged Mercury in the composite might warn of communication issues in the partnership. Some astrologers even consider composites between a person and a company (using the company’s founding chart) to gauge how that individual and the organization will mesh. In essence, the composite indicates the “*unit’s*” ability to work together harmoniously and achieve common goals ¹⁶.
- **Mundane and World Connections:** Composite charts find intriguing applications in mundane astrology as well. Because a composite can be cast for *any* two charts, astrologers have experimented with composites of nations and their leaders, of allies or even enemies. For example, one could analyze the composite chart of two world leaders or rival nations to symbolically gauge the nature of their relationship. An AstroDienst article notes that composites can be used for “people we have trouble with, or even for enemies, such as [Israeli leader] Sharon and [Palestinian leader] Arafat” ¹⁷. This use treats the composite as describing the tone of diplomatic or conflict relationships on the world stage. While not a traditional mundane technique, it provides another perspective on how two entities (even geopolitical ones) interact energetically.
- **Timing and Predictive Work:** A powerful use of composite charts is in *timing events and phases in the relationship*. Even though a midpoint composite is a symbolic chart (not tied to an exact moment in time), astrologers commonly track **transits and progressions** to the composite to predict or understand important developments in the relationship’s life cycle ¹⁸. For instance, a transit from Saturn or Uranus to the composite Sun or Ascendant often coincides with significant turning points or tests for the couple (such as a period of commitment, hardship, or change). Venus transiting the composite Descendant might correspond with a renewal of affection or partnership focus. Many astrologers report that transits to composite angles and planets “spark significant events” in the relationship, while **progressed composite** charts (which evolve as each natal chart progresses) can reveal longer-term developmental stages of the partnership ¹⁸. Relationship astrologers like Robert Blaschke have elaborated techniques for progressed composites and even **composite solar returns**, enriching the predictive toolkit ¹⁹. In practice, one might use the composite chart to look at upcoming transits as a forecast of relationship milestones – for example, a transit of Jupiter crossing the composite Midheaven could time a public step such as a marriage or joint achievement, whereas

a heavy Pluto transit to the composite Moon might signal deep emotional transformations for the couple.

In all these applications, the composite chart provides a *holistic view of the relationship* – almost as if the relationship itself were a person with a natal chart. It indicates the **combined potentials and challenges** that emerge only when the two people are together. Notably, a composite chart can even be calculated for two individuals who have not yet met in person – the midpoint “entity” exists at least in theory as soon as two birth energies are considered in relation ²⁰. In that sense, the composite is an energetic blueprint of what *would* form between those individuals. However, it truly comes to life when a relationship is actualized, and it then acts as a field of energy influencing both parties.

Psychological Dynamics of Composite Charts

Composite charts are especially valued for the **psychological insight** they offer into interpersonal dynamics. Astrologers often describe a relationship's composite as a distinct psychological entity – a *third psyche* – that is co-created by the two individuals. As astrologer **Liz Greene** explains, “two people create a third thing between them...the composite chart is like an energy field which affects both people and imposes its own dynamics on both.” ³. In other words, when two individuals form a partnership, they step into an interactive field of combined energy (the composite), which can draw out different facets of each person and shape how they behave together ³ ²¹. This helps explain why we might act one way with one partner and very differently with another – each relationship has its own chemistry and “atmosphere” defined by the composite.

Relationship as a Third Entity: A useful metaphor (originating from Jungian-influenced astrology and echoed by modern practitioners like Steven Forrest) is that “every relationship is a threesome – you, me, and what we are together.” ²². The composite chart symbolizes that “what we are together” – effectively the *relationship's personality*. Just as an individual's natal chart can be interpreted for psychological traits, the composite can be analyzed for the *psychology of the relationship*. For example, the composite Sun represents the central identity or purpose of the relationship (why these two have come together), and the composite Moon represents the emotional needs and habitual feelings that arise between them ¹². We interpret these much like we would in a natal chart, except they describe the couple *as a unit*. Greene notes that the composite has “a core identity (Sun)...emotional responses and needs (Moon)...a mode of communication (Mercury)...a distinctive set of values (Venus)...a mode of expressing will (Mars)...innate limitations (Saturn),” and so on ¹². By reading the composite's planets, signs, and houses, astrologers derive a richly detailed picture of the **relationship's character** – for instance, a composite Sun in Cancer in the 4th house with hard aspects to Saturn might depict a relationship strongly focused on home and security but burdened by feelings of restriction or parental responsibilities, suggesting a serious, emotionally demanding domestic life together.

Crucially, the composite chart often highlights themes that **neither individual may carry alone**, but which emerge only through their interaction. The whole is greater than the sum of the parts: two people may create a composite configuration that surprises them in its tone. (To illustrate, one partner alone might not have a particularly adventurous chart, but the composite could have Sagittarius rising and a packed 9th house, indicating the couple as a unit seeks grand adventures and growth experiences that neither would pursue solo.) In some cases the composite even contains astrological aspects that **neither natal chart has**, symbolizing new qualities born from the union ²³. This reflects the idea that a relationship can tap latent parts of the psyche or generate new psychological dynamics. For example, if person A is very assertive and

person B is very passive, their composite might oddly show a balanced Mars (assertion) dynamic – as if together they create a middle ground or, conversely, an exaggerated seesaw of that energy depending on how the midpoints fall.

Influence on Individual Partners: From a psychological standpoint, the composite field can strongly affect each partner – sometimes in unequal ways. The composite chart does not belong to either one person; it is *co-owned*, and both individuals interface with it through their own natal charts. This means each person will experience the relationship (the composite energy) somewhat differently, depending on how the composite chart interacts with their personal chart. Astrologers often compare the composite back to each person's natal chart to see where friction or harmony arises ²⁴. If the composite has difficult aspects to one partner's natal planets, that individual might feel more stress or discomfort in the relationship, whereas the other partner (whose natal chart is well-aligned to the composite) might feel the relationship flows easily. In Greene's words, *"two people can have a composite that harmonizes beautifully with Person A's natal chart but conflicts terribly with Person B's – Person A finds the relationship effortless while Person B feels it is draining"* ²⁵ ²⁶. This scenario is actually not uncommon and explains why relationship dynamics can feel very different to each participant. It underlines a psychological reality: our capacity to express the composite's energy is filtered through our individual makeup ²⁵.

Furthermore, certain composite planets or configurations can act like **shared psychological complexes** that the couple must navigate. For example, a composite Saturn–Pluto square might manifest as a mutual struggle with control and fear in the relationship's life – an issue that isn't solely owned by one partner, but arises when they're together. Neither individual may fully understand why this heavy feeling envelops them as a couple, since *"the relationship itself imposes it"*, as Greene notes when discussing how a composite Sun–Saturn square can thwart a couple's goals even if neither person has that issue individually ²⁷ ²⁸. In a composite, challenging aspects often represent *impersonal forces or patterns* the pair must jointly confront, almost as if the relationship has its own karma or psychological "shadow." Astrologer **Robert Blaschke** in *Relationship Analysis* even emphasizes the *"concept of the shadow"* in composite interpretation ²⁹ – suggesting that the composite chart can reveal shared shadow elements (unconscious fears, projections, or wounds) that emerge between two people. For instance, a composite 12th-house Saturn might indicate that together the couple has a tendency toward isolation or hidden sorrow that they need to bring to awareness; this could be viewed through a Jungian lens as a shadow of the relationship that needs healing.

Psychological Models and Approaches: Different astrologers have brought various psychological perspectives to composite charts. Many align with **Jungian and humanistic psychology**, treating the relationship as a vessel for individuation and growth. Liz Greene and her colleagues at the Centre for Psychological Astrology interpret composites by exploring mythic archetypes and unconscious patterns – essentially applying depth psychology to the *couple as a unit*. They often frame the composite as containing the *"joint destiny"* or *"lesson"* of the relationship ⁹, which can be worked with consciously once recognized. There is an implicit parallel to family-systems theory here: just as modern psychology views a couple or family as an emotional system with its own rules, astrologers view the composite as the horoscope of that system. The composite's aspects and house emphases can describe the system's internal dynamics, communication style, conflict patterns, and developmental stage. Astrologer **Steven Forrest** (an evolutionary astrologer) similarly emphasizes the composite chart's depiction of *the relationship's raison d'être*. He notes that the composite reveals *"the needs of the partnership in order to keep it healthy...what will make it suffocate, [and] the growth points of the couple – what 'tasks' they've come together to accomplish."* ⁸ ³⁰ In Forrest's approach, which blends psychology with a spiritual/karmic perspective, a composite chart shows the *soul contract* between two people – the evolutionary intent of why they are together, and how

they can consciously fulfill that purpose. For example, a composite North Node might indicate the direction of growth the relationship calls for, while composite South Node or Saturn could indicate karmic baggage or habits the pair must overcome ³¹ .

Another model sometimes invoked is **field theory** – the idea that the relationship creates a field of energy (emotional and psychic) that both people participate in. The composite chart can be thought of as a map of that relational field. The field theory concept, borrowed from both physics and Gestalt psychology, aligns with the astrological notion that when two energy systems (people) interact, a *third field* emerges ³² ³³ . Some astrologers describe this in almost scientific terms: “*the energy fields intersect...creating a third configuration – the composite – which is a real energy pattern*” ³⁴ ³⁵ . While the composite “field” is invisible (unlike the literal fusion of two characters in fiction or myth), it is nevertheless considered just as real in its effects ³⁶ . Viewing the composite through this lens helps astrologers and clients step back from pure subjectivity and see the relationship as an objective entity with its own needs. It encourages both partners to cooperate in addressing those needs, rather than blaming each other for dynamics that actually belong to the *relationship field*.

Fate vs. Free Will in Composites: Psychological astrologers sometimes grapple with the *degree of changeability* in a composite chart. Because the composite represents a third entity that neither individual controls outright, it can feel “fated” – an agenda that the relationship will push forth regardless of personal wish. Liz Greene points out that while individuals can do inner work to express their natal chart potentials in healthier ways, a relationship itself “*cannot go into psychotherapy*” or unilaterally decide to change its composite aspects ²⁷ ³⁷ . For example, if a composite chart has a difficult Sun-Saturn square, the relationship may continually encounter external obstacles or a sense of limitation that isn’t easily resolved by one partner trying harder – it’s a pattern inherent to the union ²⁷ . This doesn’t mean the individuals are powerless; rather, the work becomes **joint**: the couple might need to adjust their expectations or strengthen their teamwork in response to that pattern, essentially changing *their relationship to the relationship*. Greene suggests that a psychological approach to composites involves accepting some givens (certain composite themes may always manifest at some level), while finding *conscious ways to engage with them* so that the relationship’s potential is used constructively ³⁸ ³⁹ . In our Sun-Saturn example, that might mean both people acknowledging the need for patience and commitment as part of their relationship’s purpose, thereby reducing feelings of personal failure or blame when delays occur. This perspective integrates depth psychology’s emphasis on awareness and choice with the acknowledgement that a composite chart, like a natal chart, has an underlying blueprint that remains consistent.

Different astrologers emphasize different facets: **John Townley** in his original work approached composite interpretation in a practical, experiential way – he examined how composite placements correspond to real-life relationship scenarios and advised looking at concrete factors like the house with most planets, Sun/Moon aspects, and so on ⁴⁰ . **Robert Hand**, in *Planets in Composite*, offered a systematic method for reading composites (e.g. first evaluate each person’s natal relating capacity, then composite house emphases, then composite Sun/Moon, etc.) ⁴¹ , and his interpretations are known for being straightforward and sometimes bluntly realistic ⁴² . Both Hand and Townley focus on how the composite’s configurations play out in observable behavior and circumstances, which often naturally leads to psychological insight (since external patterns usually reflect internal dynamics). **Liz Greene** and others in the psychological astrology school delve more into the inner meaning and developmental lessons of composite patterns, using myth and psyche to interpret them (her seminar-turned-book *Relationships and How to Survive Them* devotes considerable attention to composites) ⁴³ ⁷ . **Steven and Jodie Forrest** in *Skymates II* frame the composite as revealing a couple’s “*combined evolution*” – what the relationship is

asking them to learn or do together – thereby blending practical interpretation with soul-centered psychology. And **Robert Blaschke** integrated *many* techniques (midpoints, progressions, harmonics) but also discussed Jungian concepts like the shadow, indicating that even highly technical analysis benefits from a psychological lens ¹⁹ .

Despite variations in approach, virtually all modern astrologers agree on the fundamental point: **the composite chart describes the relationship's own identity and dynamics**, which can profoundly illuminate the psychological interplay between two people. It externalizes the relationship as if it were a third person, allowing both partners (and the astrologer) to discuss its traits more objectively – “*the way this relationship tends to feel and behave*” – rather than casting blame solely on one party or the other. This makes it an invaluable tool for counseling and personal growth. For example, if a couple is struggling with trust, and the composite chart shows Neptune (planet of illusion/confusion) in the composite 7th house of partnership square composite Saturn (fear) in the 4th, an astrologer might gently explain that *both* are likely experiencing a pattern of uncertainty and inhibition in the relationship that isn't anyone's fault per se, but a condition of their bond to be mindfully managed. This reframes the issue as “*our challenge*” instead of “*your fault*”, aligning with sound psychological practice in relationships.

Key Figures and Evolution of Composite Chart Practice

Since the 1970s, numerous astrologers have contributed to the theory and interpretation of midpoint composite charts. Here are some of the **key figures** in its development and how their work shaped composite chart usage:

- **John Townley (b. 1945):** Credited as the *originator* of composite charts, Townley introduced the technique in 1973 with his book *The Composite Chart* ⁴⁴ . Prior to this, astrologers had long compared charts (synastry), but Townley's idea of creating an actual midpoint chart for the relationship was revolutionary. He reportedly developed it during his Saturn return, seeking a better way to understand relationship dynamics ⁴⁵ . Townley's early work provided many of the interpretive basics and case studies that showed composites “work” in describing couples' lives. In 2000 he released *Composite Charts: The Astrology of Relationships* (revisiting the topic with updated insights) ⁴⁶ . His style is approachable and research-oriented – he pioneered various techniques (including relating composite patterns to actual events in relationships) and emphasized how to synthesize natal, synastry, and composite information ⁴⁷ . Townley is still active; as of a 2017 interview he continued to share insights (e.g. via his website AstroCocktail) and reflect on composite charts' implications ⁴⁸ . His legacy is that virtually every astrologer practicing relationship astrology today owes the concept of midpoint composites to Townley's initial innovation.
- **Robert Hand (b. 1942):** A highly respected astrologer and scholar, Hand popularized composites among both astrologers and enthusiasts with his book *Planets in Composite: Analyzing Human Relationships* (first published 1975) ⁴⁹ . This was one of the first comprehensive composite chart “cookbooks,” providing interpretations for composite planets in houses and aspects, as well as guidance on casting the chart and several example cases ⁵⁰ . Hand's interpretations are noted for their depth and candor – they explore positive potentials but also frank challenges (“some of them can even sting,” as one review notes ⁴²). The AstroDienst website's composite chart readings are actually drawn from Hand's work ⁵¹ , a testament to its enduring authority. Hand also outlined a methodical approach to reading composites (looking at house emphases, Sun/Moon placement and aspects, angles, etc.) which many astrologers have adopted or adapted ⁴¹ ⁵² . He remains active in

astrology (as of 2025), lecturing and writing; while his later focus expanded to medieval astrology and research, *Planets in Composite* remains a classic reference for relationship astrology. Hand's forward byline or involvement in composite chart software features (like report writers) further cemented the technique's place in modern practice.

- **Liz Greene (b. 1946):** A luminary in psychological astrology, Greene's influence comes from integrating composite charts into Jungian and transpersonal counseling contexts. While not an "inventor" of composites, she was one of the first to deeply examine their psychological meaning, notably in seminars during the 1990s (e.g. **"The Composite Chart: Relationships and How to Survive Them,"** London, 1997 ⁵³). In these teachings (later available through the CPA), Greene emphasized the concept of the relationship as an independent entity or "child" of the two parents' charts ⁵⁴. She brought attention to how the composite doesn't show *what you feel about your partner*, but rather what *the two of you together create and experience*, often at an unconscious level ⁷. Her rich archetypal interpretations (for instance, seeing a composite Venus-Pluto as the theme of intense love-transformation in the *relationship's* psyche) and her discussions of fate vs. free will in composites ²⁷ ³⁸ have significantly shaped how astrologers approach composite charts in counseling. Greene continues to be active through writing and teaching (though semi-retired from public workshops), and her published works (like *Relating* and CPA seminars) remain foundational references for a psychological approach to relationship charts.
- **Steven Forrest (b. 1949) and Jodie Forrest:** As prominent figures in modern evolutionary astrology, the Forrests authored *Skymates* Volumes 1 and 2 (Vol. 2: *The Composite Chart*, published in the mid-2000s) ⁵⁵. They framed composite charts in the context of soul growth and karma between partners. Steven Forrest often calls the composite the "third entity" or "the hidden third wheel in every relationship" ²², highlighting its independent life. The Forrests' work is known for its accessible, narrative style – they provide practical delineations but always with an eye to how the relationship can *evolve*. For instance, they might interpret a composite North Node in the 10th house as indicating the couple's shared evolutionary task to contribute something visible to the world, and give guidance on fulfilling that mission. Their influence has made composite charts more mainstream for a new generation of astrologers; many contemporary practitioners cite *Skymates II* as a go-to manual for composite interpretation alongside the earlier classics. Steven Forrest remains very active (writing, teaching, podcasts), keeping composite analysis fresh and relevant to modern relationships which come in many forms.
- **Robert P. Blaschke (1953–2011):** Blaschke was an astrologer who deeply integrated composite charts into a broader relationship astrology framework. His book *Relationship Analysis* (2004) is lauded as one of the most extensive treatments of the subject ⁵⁶. Blaschke taught the theory behind composites and Davison charts, introduced advanced techniques (like midpoints within composites, synastry midpoints, etc.), and pioneered the use of **progressed composites and composite transits** in forecasting relationship developments ¹⁹. He also wasn't afraid to delve into esoteric and psychological territory – covering the "shadow" in relationships, karmic points like the vertex, and even *mirror synastry* (Antiscia) in the same volume ²⁹. His work helped bridge purely technical analysis with meaningful counseling perspectives. Although Blaschke tragically passed away in 2011 ⁵⁷, his contributions live on in the detailed methodologies astrologers use (for example, many now routinely examine the progressed composite Moon or composite Lunar returns when timing relationship milestones, concepts Blaschke advocated). He is remembered as a meticulous researcher who brought great clarity to composite and relationship astrology.

- **Other Contributors:** Many other astrologers have added to the dialogue on composites. **Erin Sullivan**, for example, has humorously dubbed it the “compost chart” (for all the transformative material it contains) ⁵⁸, even as she teaches its serious implications. The late **Noel Tyl** included composite chart analysis in his astrologer training texts, focusing on how the composite’s rulers and midpoints signal relationship themes. The **Huber School** of astrology (Bruno & Louise Huber) adopted a version of composite technique (which they called the “Composite Chart” but actually calculates like a Davison midpoint-in-time chart) in the 1980s, bringing it into their psychological astrology approach in Europe. And today, countless astrologers on online platforms and forums use composite charts routinely for relationship readings, often blending insights from all the above pioneers. Reputable platforms like Astrodienst, Astro-Seek, and others make composite charts easily accessible, complete with interpretations from experts (e.g. Astrodienst’s reports by Hand and others) ⁵¹. This ubiquity means that even casual astrology enthusiasts are aware that *beyond Sun-sign compatibility, there is a composite chart that tells the story of the relationship* ⁴.

In summary, midpoint-based composite charts have evolved from a novel idea in the 1970s to a staple of modern astrological practice. They are used not only to analyze romance, but to understand **any partnership or group** as a unique entity. Their power lies in offering a bird’s-eye view of a relationship’s psychological and practical dynamics – a view that complements synastry by focusing on the “us” rather than “me versus you.” Through the work of astrologers like Townley, Hand, Greene, Forrest, Blaschke and others, composites have been applied to counseling, timing life events, and even exploring the spiritual purpose of relationships. They remind us that in astrology, as in life, the whole formed by two people can indeed be something greater and more complex than either person alone – a cosmic collaboration written in the stars ¹¹ ⁸.

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